

pretty decent people under the surface. Of course, Undertale took us by surprise in other ways. When faced with moral choices, it's easy to go, "I'll just save here, see what happens, and reload". Yeah, that's not going to work with Undertale, because it knows what you've done.

Journey

Journey is one of those games that leave the deciphering to the players. There's no dialogue, no NPCs, just you and the world, and possibly a silent companion (another player) you need to work alongside in order to solve the game's puzzles and make it to your destination. So what does it all mean? Oh, so many things. There's plenty of symbolism in the game, and enough for anyone

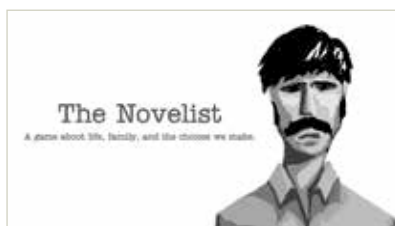


to find the meaning they're looking for. Is the game about life? The journey is more important than the destination. Evolution? This barren, ruinous landscape was once a thriving empire, but life finds a way. Is it trust? Trust in the stranger who's helping you and help those who come after you. There's no real way to find out other than experiencing the game yourself. But if playing the game evoked any kind of emotion in you at all, we guess it did its job.

The Novelist

The Novelist is an interesting game where you take on the role of a ghost who's haunting a holiday home. When a family consisting of a father who is a frustrated writer, and a mother who is a painter moves in, you have the power to influence their decisions. Will they choose their ambitions over the family? What's more important?

These are some pretty heavy decisions, but ultimately, the lesson here is responsibility and sacrifice; finding the right balance between



ambition and your loved ones, and knowing which should take priority.

Papers, Please

Papers, Please puts you in the shoes of a nameless border agent of a dystopian country called Arstotzka. As the border agent, it's your job to ensure that only true citizens of the "Great Arstotzka!" can enter the country. You do this by checking each traveller's documents and making sure everything is legit. If you see any inconsistencies, you reject them and move on. While the criteria are simple initially, over time restrictions become a lot more complex, requiring you to scrutinise every detail. There will be people who come in with heart wrenching



stories, but with the wrong documentation. Do you let them through or detain them? Say you let them through, but then in the news the next day you see that somebody bombed the ministry of defence. Was that your fault? Well, you'll never know.

This War of Mine

There are plenty of games where you're put in the shoes of soldiers in a war setting. It's impossible to count them on both hands at this point.

However, This War of Mine puts you in the shoes of a group of civilians in a war torn land who are desperately trying to survive. It's easy not to notice the carnage and destruction that war inflicts on the land when you're the one doing the carnage and destruction. This War of Mine pro-



vides you with another, much grimmer perspective. It gives you a peek into the lives of the unwilling victims of the whole ordeal.

Shelter

Shelter is a simple, minimalistic game where the player controls a mother badger and her five children, as she attempts to feed them and protect them from the wild. Shelter teaches us about nature and the cycle of life. As the mother badger, you're desperately trying to keep your children alive. However, things can go wrong at any time, be



it the environment, accidents, or predators. You may wake up one night and notice that you only have four cubs following you, but you have no time to panic or even look for the missing cub. You have to move on, you have no choice if you want to survive. After all, it's survival of the fittest.

Celeste

Celeste explores feelings of doubt, anxiety and failure, as the protagonist Madeline attempts to make her way to the peak of Mount Celeste.